

Chapter 97 - Relationship

Yan Lin froze in place, as if she hadn't yet processed what Feng Yue's words meant.

Seeing her not moving, Feng Yue furrowed her brows slightly, looking somewhat awkward, "What... what's wrong?"

Yan Lin stared straight at Feng Yue, the aggressive intensity bursting from those eyes was impossible to ignore. She licked her dry lips, her voice somewhat hoarse, "Together... you and I?"

"Mm." Feng Yue responded glumly, then sat on the bedside and bent down to put on her shoes.

Yan Lin didn't speak, just silently stepped forward and crouched in front of Feng Yue, grasping Feng Yue's ankle with one hand and placing it on her thigh.

Feng Yue's toes were round and fair. Being stared at so directly by Yan Lin made her face somewhat embarrassed, and she even restlessly curled her toes.

Yan Lin said nothing and did nothing, just carefully and quietly helped Feng Yue put on her socks and then her shoes.

Until Yan Lin had finished putting shoes on both of Feng Yue's feet and gently released them, the red glow on Feng Yue's face still hadn't faded.

Yan Lin had probably gained experience from packing several times before. By the time the hotel attendant led them to their new room, they were ready for everything.

Twenty minutes later, Yan Lin bid farewell to the attendant and closed the door to their new deluxe king room.

This room was indeed much larger than that twin room, with very complete equipment and facilities. Most importantly, the king bed was large enough for both Feng Yue and Yan Lin to lie on together.

Feng Yue wheeled around the room exploring, while Yan Lin took this opportunity to reorganize their luggage properly.

The deluxe king room had a very large floor-to-ceiling window from which you could see the entire Tokyo night scene. Feng Yue was currently positioned in front of this window.

"Ah Yue." Yan Lin's voice came from behind Feng Yue.

Feng Yue turned to look at her.

Yan Lin turned her wheelchair around, then crouched down naturally, gazing up at Feng Yue from below with smiling eyes, "Thank you."

Feng Yue looked at her, at those eyes full of sunshine, thinking for the countless time that Yan Lin was born to be so radiant - even sunlight falling on her was merely an accompaniment.

Much less a small, dying rose.

Feng Yue didn't respond, but calmly brushed away the hand that was resting on her knee, controlling the wheelchair to turn away.

Yan Lin looked at her empty palm, momentarily stunned.

"Yan Lin, you've helped me many, many times on this trip, and saved me several times before. What I've done doesn't amount to much."

Yan Lin silently stood up, looking at the back of the person in front of her with complex emotions. She thought, this person was truly ruthless - every time she thought she had grasped her, she would cruelly push her back into the abyss.

Hearing these words from Yan Lin, what didn't she understand?

The meaning behind Feng Yue's words was: I'm doing this because of those things you helped me with before, not because of you as a person.

Was Yan Lin heartbroken?

Heartbroken.

Was Yan Lin angry?

Yan Lin thought about it - although her heart was bitter and shocked, she couldn't muster any anger at all.

She felt that all her temper toward Feng Yue had been completely worn away in that cold hospital room from their previous life.

Neither of them seemed to take this brief conversation to heart, or perhaps they both buried it in the deepest part of their hearts.

Japan's cherry blossoms were world-famous, but no matter how beautiful the scenery, you'd get tired of seeing it every day. So another important reason for coming to Japan as their second stop was that Jiang Si wanted to shop.

In Sri Lanka, Jiang Si had basically bought nothing substantial, so after seeing enough cherry blossoms, she consulted with Feng Yue about where to start shopping.

A few days later, Ginza¹, Omotesando², and Shinjuku³ had been thoroughly explored by the mother and daughter, and they had bought a pile of miscellaneous things.

Meanwhile, Yan Lin became increasingly silent, like a robot that only knew how to silently follow beside Feng Yue each day, taking care of her every word and action.

After a long time, even Jiang Si felt stifled for her.

So, taking advantage of a moment when Yan Lin wasn't by Feng Yue's side, Jiang Si pulled Feng Yue into her room.

Feng Yue was pushed into the room by her mother. She couldn't see Jiang Si's expression but could feel her movements were somewhat hurried.

"Mom, what's wrong?" Feng Yue asked, turning her head.

Jiang Si pushed her into the room, then took Feng Yue's hand and sat down on the sofa together.

"Dear, tell me honestly - what exactly is your relationship with Ah Lin right now?"

Hearing this, Feng Yue's expression froze. Her mother's question had completely stumped her.

What was their relationship now?

Ambiguous partners? Divorced couple?

Feng Yue herself wasn't clear. Her relationship with Yan Lin wasn't that simple, but if she had to accurately use one word to summarize their relationship, she couldn't say it.

Jiang Si saw Feng Yue's expression and sighed, "Dear, then let me ask you - after you return to the country, are you going to remarry Ah Lin?"

Remarry? Who's remarrying? Her and Yan Lin?

Feng Yue suddenly laughed and shook her head, "How could we remarry? It's impossible for me and her to remarry."

Jiang Si looked at Feng Yue's smile that was uglier than crying, her brows slightly furrowed. She always felt this child was hiding something important from her.

But she also understood Feng Yue's temperament - once she made up her mind to hide something, Feng Yue would absolutely never tell her halfway through.

"Alright, Mom doesn't know what happened between you two, and I've guessed that you must be hiding something from me and your father." Jiang Si glanced at Feng Yue's expression as she spoke. Sure enough, Feng Yue's expression instantly stiffened for a moment. She withdrew her gaze and continued, "Mom won't ask what you're hiding, but ever since Ah Lin came to Japan, she's become quieter and more silent day by day. Although her personality was cold before, it wasn't to the point where you couldn't see her voluntarily say a word for ten days or half a month like now."

Feng Yue lowered her gaze. She knew in her heart that Yan Lin's silence had started after their brief conversation by the floor-to-ceiling window that day.

Later, Jiang Si said some other things to Feng Yue, but she no longer remembered them. What she kept thinking about was the question Jiang Si had asked her.

What exactly was her relationship with Yan Lin now?

Even after she and Yan Lin lay down together that night, Feng Yue was still troubled by this question.

Yan Lin had been putting all her thoughts on Feng Yue day after day, so naturally she also noticed something was off about Feng Yue.

Had something happened to Ah Yue?

Yan Lin was somewhat worried. She wanted to ask but didn't know how to bring it up.

The two lay flat on the bed, each covered with their own blanket, with about half an arm's length between them.

The room plunged into darkness, the only light being moonlight seeping through the curtain gaps.

Neither closed their eyes, staring straight at the dark ceiling.

Feng Yue thought for a long time but couldn't come up with an answer. So on this quiet and peaceful night, Feng Yue's voice sounded in Yan Lin's ear.

"Yan Lin."

"Mm, I'm here."

"What kind of relationship should we be now?" Feng Yue's voice sounded somewhat empty. This question seemed like a casual inquiry, yet also like she urgently needed to find an answer.

Yan Lin turned to her side, extending her long arm to pull Feng Yue to face her lying on her side.

The two looked at each other. Yan Lin's voice was very gentle, like a layer of gauze floating down from the horizon and landing on your heart, "Ah Yue, I'm pursuing you. I'm your suitor, and you're the person I love."

"Regardless of other people, regardless of our past life, I'm simply pursuing you. We have the relationship of pursuer and pursued, the relationship where I love you and am willing to give everything for you."

Feng Yue looked at her. Whether it was wind blowing in front of her eyes or wind stirring in her heart, a crystal tear overflowed from the corner of her eye, sliding across her nose bridge and falling onto the pillow, spreading into a small wet stain.

Feng Yue's throat felt as if someone was gripping it tightly - she couldn't say a word.

Seeing her continuously falling tears, Yan Lin suddenly became flustered. Her tone was no longer as firm as before, but filled with heartache, "Ah Yue, what's wrong? Why are you crying?"

Yan Lin extended her hand to continuously wipe away her tears, but Feng Yue's eyes were like an open faucet, constantly releasing water that couldn't be wiped clean no matter how much she tried.

Feng Yue didn't know why she was crying or why she would cry. She just suddenly felt her nose sting and her eye sockets heat up.

She felt as if she had been waiting for these words for a long time. When she suddenly heard them, those tears became uncontrollable.

Seeing more and more tears fall, Yan Lin lifted her own blanket with one hand and with a long-armed embrace, pulled Feng Yue along with her blanket into her own covers.

Feng Yue buried her head in Yan Lin's neck, and Yan Lin felt scalding tears falling onto her skin drop by drop.

She patted Feng Yue's back repeatedly while murmuring, "Don't cry, don't cry. It's all my fault. I must have made you angry again. You can scold me or hit me, just please don't cry, okay?"

Feng Yue's tears came silently. Even her sobs were suppressed tightly in her throat, making Yan Lin's heart feel like it was breaking.

However long Feng Yue cried, Yan Lin held her and gently comforted her for that long. Until Feng Yue gradually calmed down did Yan Lin release her.

Feng Yue was probably tired from crying and had already closed her eyes and fallen into deep sleep, though she still occasionally sobbed.

Yan Lin looked at the tears hanging from Feng Yue's eyelashes, gently placed a kiss on her forehead, then got up to go to the bathroom to wring out a hot towel and gently wiped the tear stains from Feng Yue's face.

Looking at Feng Yue's increasingly fair and tender face in the moonlight, Yan Lin nodded with satisfaction, then lay back down on the bed.

Only this time there were no separate blankets, and no half-arm's distance between them.

Instead, Yan Lin slipped into Feng Yue's blanket and extended her arms to hold her firmly in her embrace.

Perhaps because Yan Lin had let some wind in when she lifted the blanket, when she embraced Feng Yue again, she nuzzled into her arms like a small creature seeking warmth, found a comfortable position in her embrace, and completely fell into sweet dreams.

Footnotes:

1. **銀座 (Ginza)** - Tokyo's most famous upscale shopping district, known for luxury brands and department stores.
2. **表参道 (Omotesando)** - A fashionable shopping street in Tokyo, famous for its tree-lined avenue and designer boutiques.
3. **新宿 (Shinjuku)** - One of Tokyo's major commercial and business districts, known for shopping, entertainment, and nightlife.

